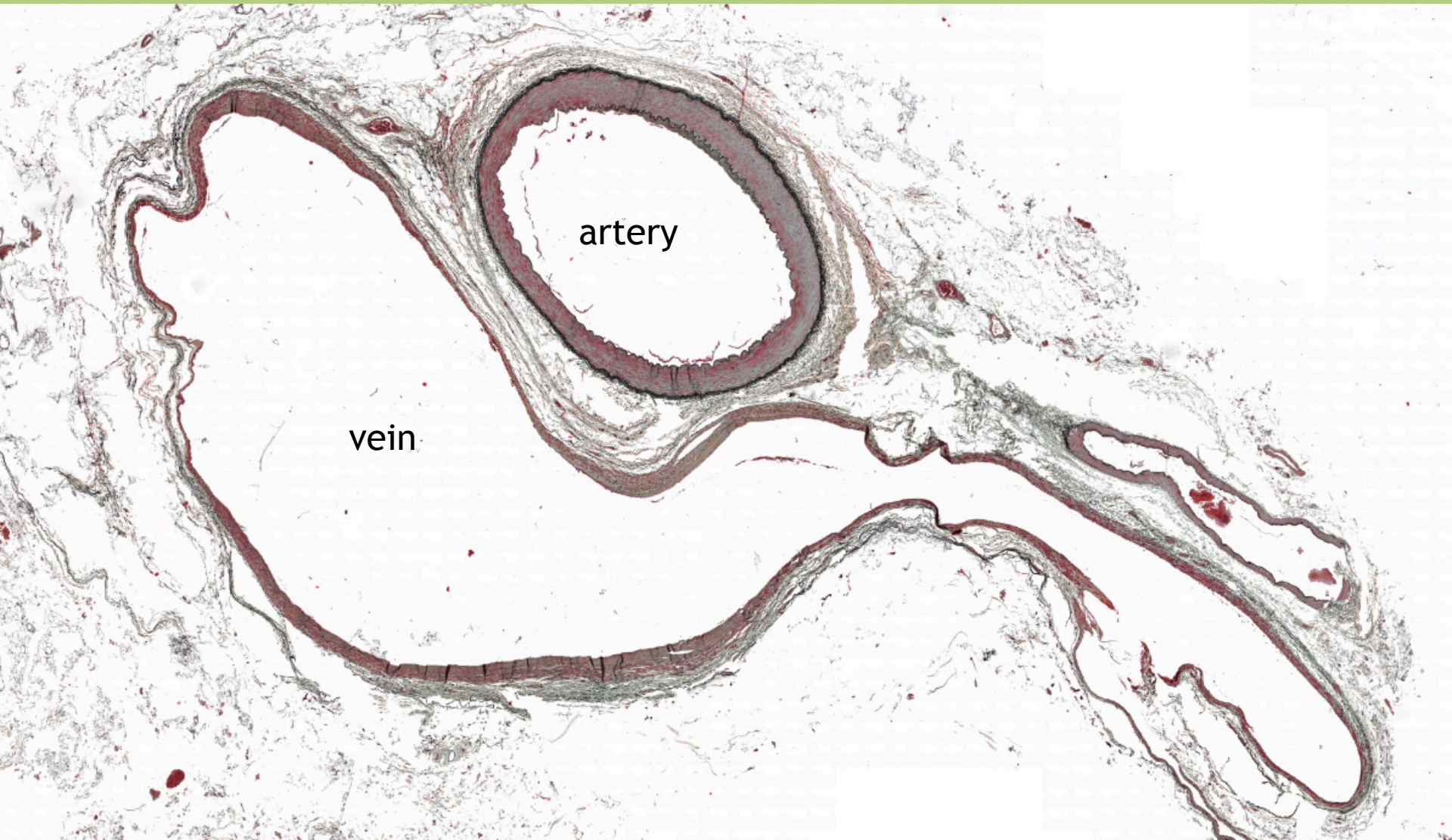


Blood vessels



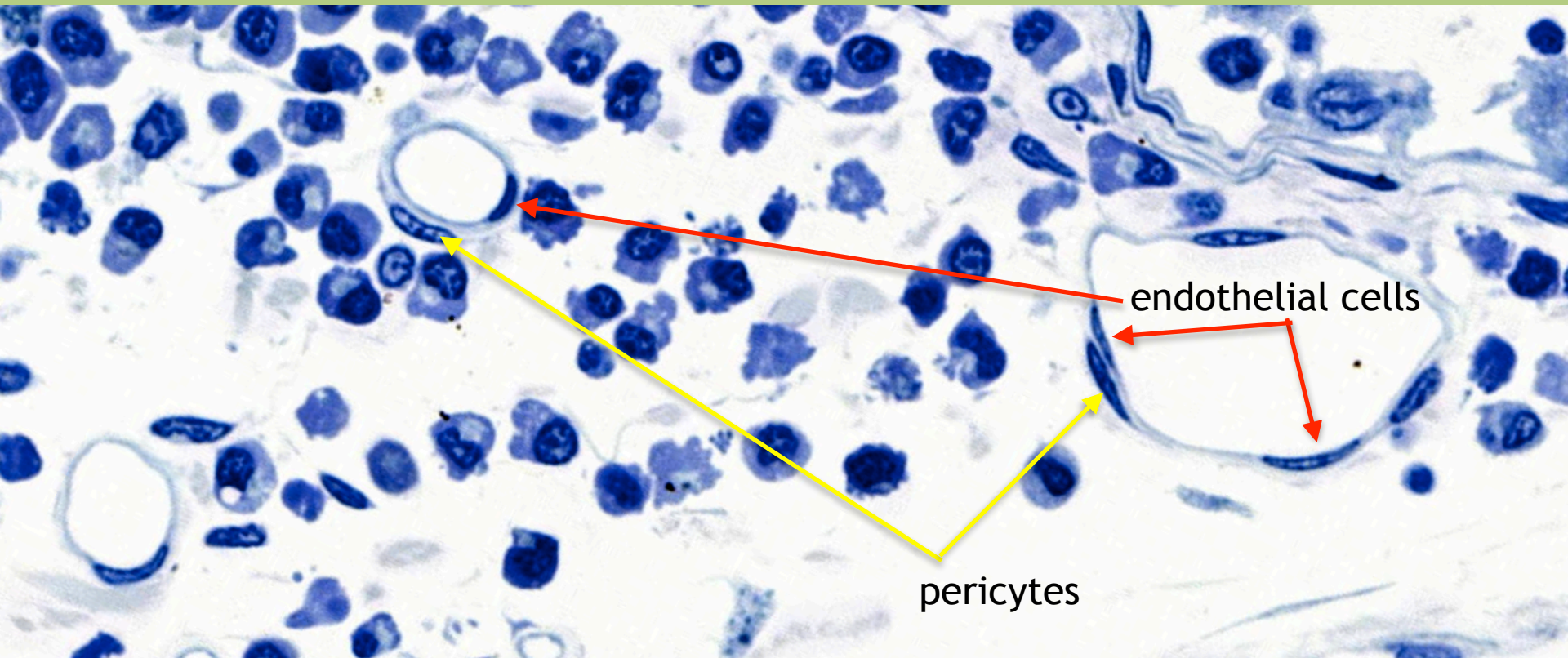
Layers of vascular wall

Tunica intima: *endothelial cells*

Tunica media: *circumferentially arranged layers of smooth muscles cells.* In arteries, this layer is relatively thick.

Tunica adventitia: *outermost connective tissue layer.* In veins, it is quite thick.

Types of vessels: capillaries



Pericytes: they are contractile cells and provide support for capillaries and postcapillary venules. Histologically, pericytes display features of undifferentiated mesenchymal stem cells.